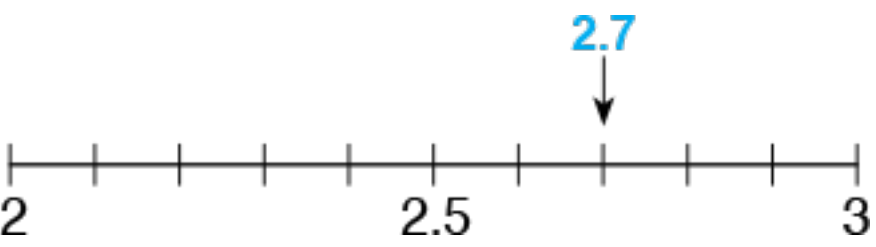


Rounding Decimals

Look at the number line. Is the decimal 2.7 closer to 2 or to 3?

The decimal 2.7 rounds to the whole number 3.



Rounding to the nearest whole number means to figure out which whole number the decimal is closest to. You often round to the nearest whole number when you shop. To round a decimal to a certain place value, look at the decimal to the right of the desired place.

Example 1

Hide

At the drug store, you buy items costing \$3.99, \$5.29, and \$7.89. You have a \$20 bill. Do you have enough money?

You can use rounding to estimate the amount of money the items cost. Round each item to the nearest dollar.

\$3.99 rounds to \$4	Add:	\$4
\$5.29 rounds to \$5		\$5
\$7.89 rounds to \$8	+	\$8
		\$17

Even adding about \$2 for sales tax, you should have enough money.

Example 2

Hide

Round 13.648 and 13.6712 to the nearest tenth.

Step 1

Identify the place you need to round to. Many students find it useful to underline this digit.

13.648

13.6712

Step 2

Look at the digit immediately to the right of the underlined digit.

If the digit to the right is less than 5, leave the underlined digit as is. Drop all the remaining digits to the right.

13.648

4 is less than 5.

The digit doesn’t change.

13.648 rounds to **13.6**

If the digit to the right is 5 or more, add 1 to the underlined digit and drop the remaining digits.

If the digit to the right is 5 or more, add 1 to the underlined digit and drop the remaining digits.

13.6712

7 is more than 5.

Add 1 to the 6 and drop the rest.

13.6712 rounds to **13.7**

Knowing how to round is crucial to interpreting calculator results.

After dividing \$9 by 7, a calculator display reads: 9÷7 1.285714286

To round to 2 decimal places, you need 3 places. The thousandths place is equal to 5, so round up and drop the remaining digits. 1.285 rounds to 1.29

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Lesson 1: Number Sense

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